

D764

Individualized Education Plan (IEP) Collaboration and Communication with Parents and School Staff

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A school schedules an annual IEP meeting for a fourth grader who spends most of the day in general education. Attending are the parent, the special education teacher, the school psychologist, and the assistant principal, who can commit district resources. The meeting is in a room with a round table and the school nurse sent a health update. Who is missing?

- A. No one; the team is complete.
- B. The school nurse
- C. A general education teacher
- D. A second special education teacher

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

At an IEP meeting, the team agrees the student needs a daily one-to-one aide, but no one present can commit district resources. What is the problem?

- A. The required district representative with authority to commit resources is missing.
- B. The general education teacher must pay for the aide.
- C. No problem; the parent can approve the aide.
- D. Aides can never be added at an IEP meeting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A present levels statement says a sixth grader reads 60 words correct per minute (grade-level benchmark: 140) and answers 3 of 10 literal questions correctly. She enjoys drawing and has two younger siblings. Which annual goal connects best to this PLAAFP?

- A. She will read 140 words correct per minute by the end of the year.
- B. She will draw pictures to show understanding.
- C. She will improve in math computation.
- D. Given a sixth-grade passage, she will read 90 words correct per minute and answer 8 of 10 literal questions correctly.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

During an IEP meeting, the school psychologist reports, “Her FSIQ was in the low average range with a significant PSW in phonological processing.” The parent nods and says nothing. The meeting started ten minutes late and snacks were provided. What should the case manager do?

- A. Apologize for starting late and end early.
- B. Hand the parent the full technical report to read later.
- C. Restate the results in plain words, start with her strengths, and ask the parent what questions she has.
- D. Move on, since the parent nodded.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A school wants to improve family engagement for students with IEPs. It already sends a monthly newsletter in three languages, and the building has a new parent room with a coffee maker. Which plan best reflects two-way partnership?

- A. Add a fourth language to the newsletter.
- B. Send home the draft IEP to sign and return.
- C. Invite families only when there is a problem.
- D. Before each IEP meeting, ask families what works at home, their goals, and their concerns, and use their answers in the draft.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

After an IEP meeting, parents disagree with the school’s decision to reduce speech services. The school, which has a new principal and a busy spring testing calendar, wants to require mediation before anything else. What is accurate?

- A. Parents’ only option is to accept the decision.
- B. Mediation is voluntary; the parents may choose it, file a state complaint, or request due process.
- C. Disputes wait until testing season ends.
- D. Parents must complete mediation before any other step.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which dispute option leads to a decision by an impartial hearing officer after both sides present evidence?

- A.** A facilitated IEP meeting
- B.** A due process hearing
- C.** A parent-teacher conference
- D.** Mediation

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

The general education teacher cannot attend an annual IEP meeting where the student's reading instruction in her class will be discussed. The meeting is on a Friday and the student recently won a spelling bee. What is required to excuse her?

- A.** Written agreement from the parent and district, and her written input submitted before the meeting.
- B.** A phone call to the parent the morning of the meeting.
- C.** Nothing; teachers may skip meetings on Fridays.
- D.** She may never be excused.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

The occupational therapist will miss an IEP meeting where OT will not be discussed or changed. What is required to excuse her?

- A.** Written agreement plus her written input.
- B.** Nothing at all.
- C.** Written agreement between the parent and the district.
- D.** A new evaluation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A 17-year-old's IEP meeting will discuss postsecondary goals. The case manager wants to invite a vocational rehabilitation counselor. The student works weekends at a garden center, and the meeting room seats 12. What must happen?

- A.** Invite the counselor without consent, since it helps the student.
- B.** Leave the student out to keep the meeting short.
- C.** Invite the garden center manager instead.
- D.** Invite the student, and get parent consent before inviting the vocational rehabilitation counselor.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student is invited to her transition IEP meeting but chooses not to attend. What must the team do?

- A.** Cancel the meeting until she attends.
- B.** Take other steps to make sure her preferences and interests are considered.
- C.** Write goals based only on the parents' wishes.
- D.** Remove transition planning from the IEP.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

At an IEP meeting, a father says angrily, "Nobody here listens. My son is falling further behind every year." The room is warm and the meeting has run 45 minutes. What should the special education teacher say first?

- A.** "You're worried he keeps losing ground and that your concerns haven't been heard. Can you tell us more about what you're seeing?"
- B.** "That is not true; we always listen."
- C.** "Our policy is to follow the data, and the data say he is progressing."
- D.** "Let's take a break because it's warm in here."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A school schedules an annual IEP meeting for a fourth grader who spends most of the day in general education. Attending are the parent, the special education teacher, the school psychologist, and the assistant principal, who can commit district resources. ~~The meeting is in a room with a round table and the school nurse sent a health update.~~ Who is missing?

Target word: missing required member **Decides:** A general education teacher is required when the child is in general education.

A	Dropped element	Drops the general education teacher requirement.
B	Camouflage	The nurse is optional; her update does not make her required.
C	Correct	Required because the student spends most of the day in general education.
D	Wrong stem number	One special educator is required, not two.

2. Answer A Concept 1 · transfer

At an IEP meeting, the team agrees the student needs a daily one-to-one aide, but no one present can commit district resources. What is the problem?

Target word: role of the district representative **Decides:** The LEA representative must be able to commit resources.

A	Correct	Without that member, the team cannot ensure services will be provided.
B	Adjacent category	Teachers do not commit district funds.
C	Inverted operation	Parents agree to services but cannot commit district resources.
D	Absolute language	Teams add supports when needed and resources are committed.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A present levels statement says a sixth grader reads 60 words correct per minute (grade-level benchmark: 140) and answers 3 of 10 literal questions correctly. ~~She enjoys drawing and has two younger siblings.~~ Which annual goal connects best to this PLAAFP?

Target word: goal linked to present levels **Decides:** Goals must address needs named in the PLAAFP with measurable criteria.

A	Wrong stem number	Copies the benchmark; not reasonable from a baseline of 60 and ignores comprehension.
B	Camouflage	Uses her interest but is not a measurable reading goal.
C	Adjacent category	Math is not a need named in this PLAAFP.
D	Correct	Targets both fluency and comprehension needs from the data, measurably.

4. Answer C Concept 3

During an IEP meeting, the school psychologist reports, “Her FSIQ was in the low average range with a significant PSW in phonological processing.” The parent nods and says nothing. ~~The meeting started ten minutes late and snacks were provided.~~ What should the case manager do?

Target word: communication fix **Decides:** Jargon plus silence means understanding is not confirmed.

A	Camouflage	The late start is irrelevant to the communication gap.
B	Adjacent category	Gives more jargon, not explanation.
C	Correct	Plain language and checking for understanding support real participation.
D	Dropped element	Silence and nodding are not proof of understanding.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A school wants to improve family engagement for students with IEPs. ~~It already sends a monthly newsletter in three languages, and the building has a new parent room with a coffee maker.~~ Which plan best reflects two-way partnership?

Target word: two-way engagement **Decides:** Families share their knowledge and it is used in planning.

A	Camouflage	Still one-way information.
B	Inverted operation	Asks for approval, not input.
C	Absolute language	Problem-only contact undercuts partnership.
D	Correct	Treats families as experts whose input shapes the plan.

6. Answer B Concept 5

After an IEP meeting, parents disagree with the school’s decision to reduce speech services. The school, ~~which has a new principal and a busy spring testing calendar,~~ wants to require mediation before anything else. What is accurate?

Target word: mediation rules **Decides:** Mediation is voluntary for both parties.

A	Absolute language	Several dispute options exist.
B	Correct	IDEA makes mediation voluntary and keeps other options open.
C	Camouflage	Testing schedules do not pause parent rights.
D	Inverted operation	Mediation cannot be required or used to delay rights.

7. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

Which dispute option leads to a decision by an impartial hearing officer after both sides present evidence?

Target word: identify due process **Decides:** Hearing officer decision = due process hearing.

A	Adjacent category	A facilitator runs the meeting; the team still decides.
B	Correct	A hearing officer hears evidence and issues a binding decision.
C	Dropped element	No impartial decision-maker is involved.
D	Confusion set	A mediator helps the sides agree but does not decide.

8. Answer A Concept 6

The general education teacher cannot attend an annual IEP meeting where the student's reading instruction in her class will be discussed. ~~The meeting is on a Friday and the student recently won a spelling bee.~~ What is required to excuse her?

Target word: excusal requirements **Decides:** Her area will be discussed.

A	Correct	Excusal when the member's area is discussed requires both.
B	Dropped element	Consent must be in writing, and input is still needed.
C	Camouflage	The day of the week is irrelevant.
D	Absolute language	Excusal is allowed with the proper written steps.

9. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

The occupational therapist will miss an IEP meeting where OT will not be discussed or changed. What is required to excuse her?

Target word: excusal when area is not discussed **Decides:** Only written agreement of parent and district.

A	Confusion set	Written input is required only when her area is discussed.
B	Dropped element	Written agreement is still required.
C	Correct	If her area is not discussed, written agreement is enough.
D	Adjacent category	Excusal has nothing to do with evaluation.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A 17-year-old's IEP meeting will discuss postsecondary goals. The case manager wants to invite a vocational rehabilitation counselor. ~~The student works weekends at a garden center, and the meeting room seats 12.~~ What must happen?

Target word: invitations for transition meeting **Decides:** Student must be invited; agency rep needs consent.

A	Dropped element	Drops the consent requirement for outside agencies.
B	Inverted operation	The student must be invited when transition is discussed.
C	Camouflage	The job detail does not decide required invitations.
D	Correct	Both are IDEA requirements for transition meetings.

11. Answer B Concept 7 · transfer

A student is invited to her transition IEP meeting but chooses not to attend. What must the team do?

Target word: when the student does not attend **Decides:** The team must take other steps to consider her preferences and interests.

A	Absolute language	The meeting may proceed.
B	Correct	IDEA requires the team to consider her views even if she is absent.
C	Dropped element	Drops the student's preferences.
D	Inverted operation	Transition planning remains required.

12. Answer A Concept 8

At an IEP meeting, a father says angrily, "Nobody here listens. My son is falling further behind every year." ~~The room is warm and the meeting has run 45 minutes.~~ What should the special education teacher say first?

Target word: first response in conflict **Decides:** Paraphrase and name the concern before problem solving.

A	Correct	Paraphrasing and inviting more shows listening and opens problem solving.
B	Absolute language	Dismisses his experience.
C	Inverted operation	Defends before listening, which raises conflict.
D	Camouflage	Room temperature does not address his concern.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Required IEP team members	The team includes the parents, at least one general education teacher (if the child is or may be in general education), at least one special education teacher, a district representative who can commit resources, someone who can interpret evaluation results, and the student when appropriate.	Holding a meeting without a general education teacher or a person able to commit resources.	A list of who is attending an IEP meeting.
2	PLAAFP drives the IEP	The present levels statement describes current performance with data and how the disability affects progress in the general curriculum; goals and services must connect to needs named there.	Writing goals from a goal bank or a diagnosis without a link to present levels.	A goal or service that does not match any stated need.
3	Plain, strengths-based communication	Explain data and terms in plain language, check understanding, and begin with the student's strengths before needs.	Using acronyms and test jargon and assuming silence means agreement.	A parent looks confused or quiet while educators talk.
4	Two-way family partnership	Families are experts on their child; engagement means asking for and using their knowledge, not only sending information home.	Equating family engagement with newsletters and sign-off forms.	A school plans to "involve" families only by informing them.
5	Dispute resolution options	IDEA offers mediation (voluntary for both sides, confidential), state complaints, and due process hearings; many states also offer facilitated IEP meetings.	Thinking mediation can be required of parents or must happen before a state complaint.	Parents and school disagree after a meeting.
6	Excusing a team member	A required member may be excused only if the parent and district agree in writing; if the member's area is discussed, the member must submit written input before the meeting.	Excusing a member with a verbal okay or on the day of the meeting with no input.	A required member cannot attend.
7	Student and agency roles in transition	The student must be invited when postsecondary goals and transition services are discussed; outside agency representatives are invited only with parent (or adult student) consent.	Inviting a vocational rehabilitation counselor without consent, or leaving the student out.	A transition IEP meeting and an outside agency.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Active listening in conflict	Paraphrase the speaker's concern and name the underlying interest before problem solving; do not defend or dismiss.	Responding to an upset parent by explaining policy first.	A parent raises a strong complaint during a meeting.

Course scope (public description): Individualized Education Plan (IEP) Collaboration and Communication with Parents and School Staff prepares special education teachers to collaborate effectively with parents, school staff, and other professionals to plan programs and access services for students with exceptionalities. This includes applying culturally responsive communication strategies within school, educational settings, and the community. The course introduces ways to enhance parental involvement and family engagement while teaching families and students advocacy throughout the Individualized Education Plan (IEP) and transition planning processes. The learner will create an IEP and then engage in a simulated IEP annual review where they will practice effective communication and collaboration skills key to the program's development and implementation. Candidates will engage in three hours of preclinical experiences that includes a simulated collaborative experience in which skills learned can be applied.